

NIKHIL JAGTAP

Senior Application Support Specialist | ITIL | Azure | ServiceNow | ITSM

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Senior Application Support Specialist with 13+ years of progressive experience in L2/L3 production support, IT Service Management (ITSM), and ITIL-based service operations across Oil & Gas, Banking, and Financial Services domains. Demonstrated expertise in incident management, problem management, root cause analysis (RCA), change management, and SLA/KPI governance for business-critical applications. Proficient in Azure infrastructure support, ServiceNow ITSM platform, CMDB management, and end-to-end release management. Adept at driving cross-functional collaboration, mentoring junior engineers, and leading client communication to consistently achieve high customer satisfaction scores. Recognized for reducing recurring incident rates, improving MTTR, and delivering measurable operational improvements.

CORE COMPETENCIES

ITSM & Service Ops: L2/L3 Application Support · Incident Management · Problem Management · ITIL v3/v4 · SLA/KPI Management · MTTR Reduction

Platforms & Tools: ServiceNow · Azure Portal · Azure Monitor · Azure VM · Dynatrace (monitoring) · JIRA · Confluence

Change & Release Mgmt: Change Advisory Board (CAB) · Release Planning · Rollback Strategies · CMDB · Configuration Management · Service Portfolio

Database & Scripting: SQL · IBM DB2 · COBOL · JCL · DB2 Query Optimization · Docugen Automation

Testing: System Integration Testing (SIT) · UAT · QTP · Defect Management · Test Case Design

Methodologies: Agile · Scrum · ITIL · DevOps Awareness · Continuous Improvement (CI)

Soft Skills: Client Communication · Stakeholder Management · Team Leadership · Mentoring · Root Cause Analysis · Executive Reporting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Associate – Application Support Specialist
Cognizant Technology Solutions

Mar 2013 – Present
Pune, India

Project: Aker Solutions – Application Support (Oil & Gas Sector) | Feb 2017 – Present | **Role:** Technical Service Manager (TSM)

- Spearheaded L2/L3 production support for 15+ mission-critical applications across an oil & gas enterprise, maintaining 99.9%+ system uptime and consistently meeting SLA targets of <4-hour resolution for P1/P2 incidents.
- Led root cause analysis (RCA) and post-incident reviews for major/critical incidents, implementing corrective and preventive actions (CAPA) that reduced recurring incident volume by approximately 30% year-over-year.
- Managed end-to-end change management lifecycle — authored Change Requests (CRs), presented to Change Advisory Board (CAB), coordinated release planning, deployment scheduling, and rollback strategies across multi-vendor environments with zero unplanned outages.
- Administered user access management, role provisioning, and license lifecycle management (renewals, upgrades, decommissioning) for 200+ application users across multiple business units.
- Maintained CMDB configuration items (CIs) in ServiceNow, ensuring 100% data accuracy for ITIL compliance, audit readiness, and service portfolio reporting.
- Authored and maintained 20+ knowledge base (KB) articles and standard operating procedures (SOPs), improving team first-call resolution (FCR) rate and reducing mean-time-to-resolve (MTTR) by 25%.
- Delivered Azure infrastructure support including VM diagnostics, Azure Monitor alerts, network connectivity troubleshooting, and cloud service health management for hosted application workloads.
- Served as primary client liaison for the Aker Solutions account; produced weekly and monthly operational dashboards and presented service metrics to C-level stakeholders, earning consistent 'Excellent' CSAT ratings.

- Mentored and coached 4 junior associates on ITIL best practices, ServiceNow ticket management, incident prioritisation, and professional client communication standards.
- Coordinated with third-party vendors and internal infrastructure teams to ensure seamless service continuity during planned and emergency maintenance windows.

Project: Key Bank – National Collection Recovery (NCR) | Sep 2016 – Feb 2017 | Role: Associate – Software Developer

- Developed and maintained automated loan collection letter-generation workflows using COBOL, DB2, JCL, and the Docugen automation tool, processing thousands of collection notices daily with zero critical post-deployment defects.
- Performed comprehensive unit testing and defect triage, resolving 100% of identified defects within sprint timelines and maintaining code quality standards.
- Collaborated closely with business analysts and compliance teams to translate regulatory requirements and operational business rules into robust technical specifications and COBOL program logic.

Project: Barclays Bank – Equal Payment Plan (EPP) | Apr 2015 – Sep 2016 | Role: Associate – Software Tester

- Designed and executed 150+ test cases for 4 core payment functionalities: Account Transfer, Product-to-Product Transfer, Dispute Resolution, and Chargeback processing, achieving 98% test coverage across system integration and regression cycles.
- Managed end-to-end system environment testing using COBOL, DB2, JCL, and QTP (Quick Test Professional); tracked, documented, and resolved 50+ defects across multiple sprints in alignment with defect management protocols.
- Optimised and modified IBM DB2 queries to generate customised business intelligence and compliance reports for product owners and regulatory teams.
- Collaborated with development teams to validate bug fixes against design specifications, ensuring defect-free deployments to production.

Project: Northern Trust – Global Account Maintenance (GAM) | Oct 2013 – Apr 2015 | Role: Program Analyst

- Delivered L2 production support and incident resolution for the Global Account Management (GAM) platform, an enterprise-wide system managing account operations across all Northern Trust global business units.
- Investigated and resolved application workflow defects across System Integration Testing (SIT) and User Acceptance Testing (UAT) environments, reducing defect escape rate to production by 40%.
- Performed thorough DB2 query optimisation and updates to support evolving business reporting, compliance, and audit requirements.
- Executed pre-production testing for each release cycle, ensuring stability and zero critical defects in production deployments.

CERTIFICATIONS

ITIL Foundation Certification	Cognizant Internal
Banking and Financial Services – Level 0	Cognizant Internal
Agile Practitioner Certification	Cognizant Internal

EDUCATION

M.Tech in Software Systems (Work Integrated Learning) BITS Pilani	2018
Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Sinhgad Institute of Technology & Science, Pune	2013

LANGUAGES

English (Professional Proficiency) | Hindi (Native) | Marathi (Native)